

YOUR COURT HEARING SCRIPT

This script helps you speak to the judge. You can bring this paper with you.

WHEN YOUR CASE IS CALLED: Walk to the front.

You: Good morning/afternoon, Your Honor. My name is Maria Elena Rodriguez.

Judge: Do you have an attorney?

You: No, Your Honor. I am representing myself.

Judge: Have you filed your Answer?

You: Yes, Your Honor. Here is a copy. (hand judge copy)

Judge: Do you owe the rent?

You: I dispute the amount claimed OR Yes, and I deposited it with the court.

EXPLAIN YOUR DEFENSE: Tell the judge briefly why you should not be evicted.

Examples: Landlord refused repairs / Retaliation / Improper notice / Already paid

IF YOU NEED MORE TIME:

You: Your Honor, I request more time to find housing or make arrangements.

CLOSING: Thank you for hearing me, Your Honor.

TIPS: Dress neatly. No phone. Do not interrupt. Bring all documents.